

Dear Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD)
National Coordination Office (NCO), National Science Foundation:

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on the development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan ("Plan"). This comment is from the Open Source Security Foundation (OpenSSF). The OpenSSF is "a community of software developers, security engineers, and more who are working together to secure open source software for the greater public good" <openssf.org>. We have over 100 members from many different industries.

We appreciate the support to avoid requirements that may hamper private sector AI innovation.

While AI has a long history, full application of modern AI techniques is relatively new. Significant experimentation and analysis is ongoing, and is enabling rapid innovation. Much of this innovation has been enabled by open source software (OSS) and open models as both of these mechanisms provide for manifold innovations across industry built on top of common best practices and protect users without compromising agility in implementation. We believe it's important to *not* stymie the development of OSS and open models, but where practical, encourage and accelerate their development. Transparency greatly accelerates the development and improvement of AI techniques, as we've seen with the dominance of traditional and modern open source across both open *and* proprietary software stacks.

We would encourage the US government, its contractors, and the research it funds to collaborate with, participate in, and contribute directly to OSS. AI is already strongly and critically dependent on a variety of OSS components, such as Pytorch and TensorFlow, which in turn build on lower-level components like NumPy. This collaboration has been and continues to be fruitful, accelerating industry understanding of models through these common components and creating an environment to continue revolutionizing modern technology with AI.

The OpenSSF and its members bring decades of experience in securing the open source supply chain which provides infrastructure components to over 97% of all software, and underpins AI model and application development and deployment. It is critical for national security and competitiveness that developers are educated on open source security best practices and that industry and government responsibly use open source software by contributing to the security of the ecosystem. We look forward to partnering with the US government to ensure policy and public-private initiatives toward this end succeed.

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Sincerely,

The Open Source Security Foundation (OpenSSF) Public Policy Committee (PPC)

Sent by David A. Wheeler <dwheeler @ linuxfoundation . org>